MASTER CHARACTER AND RELATIONSHIP DOSSIER

CORIOLANUS SNOW / EDMUND VOSS

Attack on Titan × The Ballad of Songbirds and Snakes

Essential reference for all future chapters

IMPORTANT: This document establishes the characterization, history, motivations, relationships and continuity of Coriolanus Snow, currently living under the identity Edmund Voss. It is a foundational reference for the story, not a chapter to reproduce verbatim.

Use it to maintain consistent characterization and emotional continuity throughout the narrative.

Do not introduce contradictions, change established events or simplify the characters' motivations for convenience.

I. THE CENTRAL PREMISE

Coriolanus Snow, as portrayed by Tom Blyth in *The Ballad of Songbirds and Snakes*, exists within the world of Attack on Titan.

Eight years before the present events, Snow and Levi Ackerman were lovers.

They lived together in the Underground. They were partners, companions and, for a time, genuinely happy. Their relationship was affectionate, intimate, domestic and emotionally significant to both of them.

Eventually, however, Snow's increasing ruthlessness and willingness to sacrifice other people for what he considered necessary became something Levi could no longer accept.

Their relationship ended after a confrontation in which Levi had the opportunity to kill Snow but could not bring himself to do it. Instead, Levi allowed him to leave, provided him with a way to survive aboveground, and explicitly told him never to return.

Snow left.

He did not understand that Levi meant the relationship was permanently over.

For the first three years after leaving, Snow built a peaceful life in a small village. He worked, made friends, became part of a community and experienced a relatively ordinary existence.

Then he learned that Levi was alive.

Not only alive: Levi had become Captain Levi, Humanity's Strongest Soldier.

That discovery changed the direction of Snow's life.

Over the following five years, Snow deliberately reinvented himself inside the Walls under the name Edmund Voss. He acquired education, influence, wealth, political connections and a respectable public reputation.

His objective was to return to Levi as someone capable of offering him a different future.

He believes he has become a man Levi could choose.

He does not understand that Levi already made his choice eight years ago.

This is not fundamentally a revenge story. Snow does not return because he wants to punish Levi.

He returns because he believes he is coming home.

That distinction is essential.

II. CORIOLANUS SNOW: CHARACTERIZATION

1. The source characterization

Use young Coriolanus Snow from *The Ballad of Songbirds and Snakes*, particularly Tom Blyth's portrayal, as the psychological and behavioural foundation.

Do not write him as the elderly President Snow.

He is young, physically recognizable, intelligent, articulate, ambitious, socially perceptive and capable of genuine emotional warmth.

His personality contains several seemingly contradictory qualities:

- He is charming but deeply self-interested.
- He is affectionate but possessive.
- He is intelligent enough to understand other people's emotions but not necessarily willing to respect them.

- He is capable of sincere attachment while also rationalizing actions that hurt the people he claims to love.
- He can be generous, funny and considerate.
- He is intensely concerned with his future, reputation and position.
- He dislikes appearing vulnerable or powerless.
- He prefers to control circumstances rather than openly demand control.
- He can convince himself that morally questionable actions are reasonable if he believes the outcome is justified.

He should never be written as a one-dimensional villain.

His feelings for Levi are real.

His tenderness is real.

His capacity to hurt other people is also real.

The story must allow all three things to coexist.

2. His relationship with power

Snow does not necessarily want power simply because he enjoys dominating others.

He associates power with security, independence, status and the ability to prevent himself from ever becoming vulnerable again.

He dislikes being dependent on people or circumstances he cannot control.

He wants to be someone who can make decisions instead of waiting for others to make them for him.

This tendency becomes especially important after losing Levi.

He eventually convinces himself that the problem was not his ambition or his methods, but his previous inability to provide the life Levi deserved.

In other words, he believes that if he had possessed more influence, money, status and authority, he could have prevented their separation.

He does not initially consider that Levi objected to the choices he made, not merely the circumstances surrounding them.

3. His emotional intelligence

Snow is observant.

He notices changes in tone, posture, facial expressions, hesitation and word choice.

He remembers details about people and uses this knowledge naturally.

However, his emotional intelligence has a serious limitation: he tends to interpret other people's feelings through the framework of his own desires.

He may correctly recognize that Levi is angry, hurt or uncomfortable, but conclude that those feelings are temporary and can be overcome.

He may notice Levi's closeness with Erwin and understand that it matters, while convincing himself that it cannot possibly outweigh their shared history.

He is capable of understanding what another person wants.

He struggles to accept that what they want might be incompatible with what he wants.

4. His affection

Snow is capable of sincere, wholehearted tenderness.

Do not make every affectionate interaction calculated.

He genuinely enjoys taking care of Levi, making him comfortable, touching him, listening to him and being near him.

He remembers small details because he was paying attention, not because he was constructing a strategy.

He can be playful, indulgent, teasing and occasionally almost boyish when genuinely happy.

He likes being loved by Levi. He likes knowing Levi trusts him enough to relax around him.

However, his affection gradually becomes entangled with entitlement.

He believes he knows Levi exceptionally well, and this familiarity contributes to his conviction that he understands what is best for him.

He sometimes treats their shared history as evidence that he has a privileged claim to Levi's future.

That is one of his central flaws.

III. THE UNDERGROUND: THEIR ORIGINAL LOVE STORY

1. How they met

Eight years before the present, Levi and Snow met in the Underground.

Snow was younger, educated, articulate and distinctly out of place in an environment where survival depended on very different abilities.

Levi was already resourceful, dangerous, observant and accustomed to navigating the Underground's social and physical dangers.

Their initial attraction should develop through mutual curiosity and recognition.

Snow is fascinated by Levi.

Levi is initially suspicious of Snow's polished manners, education and ability to speak his way through situations.

They recognize qualities in each other that are unusual in their respective environments.

Levi sees that Snow is more capable than his appearance initially suggests.

Snow sees that Levi is intelligent, perceptive and considerably more complicated than the reputation surrounding him.

Neither should immediately become emotionally dependent on the other.

Their connection develops naturally.

2. Their partnership

They complement each other.

Levi is physically formidable, practical and extraordinarily good at reading dangerous situations.

Snow is strategic, articulate, educated and socially intelligent.

Levi knows how to survive a confrontation.

Snow often knows how to prevent one, manipulate its circumstances or turn it to their advantage.

They become partners in more than one sense.

They share information, resources, responsibilities and decisions.

They develop a way of working together that feels almost effortless.

Snow may negotiate with people Levi would rather threaten. Levi may recognize a danger Snow has overlooked.

They are not simply a strong man protecting a weaker man.

They are two intelligent, capable people with different strengths.

Both contribute to their survival.

3. Their domestic life

This is extremely important.

Their relationship must be portrayed as genuinely loving and happy for a meaningful period of time.

They eventually live together.

Their home is modest, particularly by the standards Snow would later aspire to, but it becomes a place of safety and familiarity.

Develop a believable sense of domestic routine:

- Snow often reads while Levi works or cleans.
- Levi has particular standards concerning cleanliness and order.
- Snow occasionally teases him about his habits.
- They share meals and familiar evening routines.
- Snow sometimes returns home with something small he knows Levi will appreciate.
- Levi may complain about unnecessary purchases but still use them.
- They know each other's schedules, preferences and moods.
- They become comfortable sharing silence.
- They sometimes disagree over mundane things.
- Their affection is woven into ordinary life rather than reserved for dramatic moments.

Their home should feel lived in.

They are not constantly having profound conversations about love.

Sometimes they simply exist together.

Snow enjoys having somewhere to return to.

Levi enjoys having someone waiting for him.

They both develop an attachment to the ordinary future they imagine together.

4. Their physical affection

Snow is the more openly affectionate partner.

This is an established characteristic and must remain consistent in flashbacks and memories.

He is tactile, attentive and verbally affectionate.

His affection includes:

- Brushing Levi's hair away from his forehead.
- Touching his chin to get his attention.
- Running his fingers through Levi's hair.
- Resting a hand at Levi's waist.
- Holding him from behind.
- Kissing his forehead, temples, cheeks, nose and the top of his head.
- Occasionally kissing him simply because he is nearby.
- Playing with his hair when they are relaxing.
- Touching his face while talking to him.
- Pulling him closer without necessarily interrupting whatever they are doing.
- Praising his intelligence, appearance and abilities.
- Calling him affectionate names.
- Finding excuses to touch him.

Snow genuinely enjoys Levi's reactions.

He particularly likes the contrast between Levi's usual sharpness and the way he softens around someone he trusts.

Levi, in turn, is comfortable receiving this affection.

He may pretend to be annoyed, make sarcastic remarks or tell Snow to stop fussing over him.

But he leans into the touch.

He sometimes catches Snow's hand and keeps it where it is.

He allows Snow to play with his hair.

He may rest against him when tired.

He occasionally initiates affection himself, although he is less verbally demonstrative.

Levi does not become a completely different person when in love.

He remains Levi: reserved, blunt, sarcastic and occasionally difficult.

The difference is that he feels safe enough to let his guard down.

Their affection should feel intimate and specific to them.

Do not turn every interaction into exaggerated romantic dialogue.

A hand resting on Levi's waist while Snow reads may communicate more than an elaborate declaration.

5. The emotional foundation

Snow genuinely loves Levi.

He admires his resilience, intelligence, competence and ability to remain himself despite everything he has experienced.

He finds him beautiful, but his attraction is not limited to appearance.

He likes Levi's habits, expressions, opinions, humour and temperament.

He enjoys being challenged by him.

He likes that Levi does not automatically defer to him.

He likes that Levi sees through certain performances and can be unimpressed by things that would impress other people.

Levi, meanwhile, loves Snow's intelligence, resourcefulness, warmth and ability to make a difficult world feel less suffocating.

He appreciates having someone who can understand his silences without demanding explanations.

For a time, they are genuinely good for each other.

Do not retroactively portray their entire relationship as manipulative.

The tragedy depends on the fact that there was something real worth losing.

IV. THE DETERIORATION

1. What changes

Snow becomes increasingly ruthless.

His ambition grows, and his understanding of what is acceptable begins to shift.

At first, he may justify questionable decisions as necessary for survival.

Later, he begins making decisions that are not simply about immediate survival.

He becomes increasingly comfortable treating other people as pieces in a larger plan.

He believes that certain sacrifices are necessary to secure a better future.

He begins to expect Levi to understand.

He assumes that because they share a life, Levi will eventually accept the decisions required to protect that life.

This is where their values begin to diverge.

2. Levi's objection

Levi does not object because he is naive about the world.

He understands violence.

He understands that survival sometimes requires terrible choices.

He has lived through circumstances that have forced him to make difficult decisions himself.

The problem is that Snow begins crossing lines that Levi does not believe should be crossed.

Snow increasingly treats other people as expendable.

He begins deciding what is acceptable on behalf of people who have no say in the matter.

His reasoning may be intelligent, persuasive and even partially correct in practical terms.

But Levi cannot accept the moral framework behind it.

The issue is not that Levi expects Snow to be innocent.

It is that Levi no longer recognizes the man making these decisions as someone he can continue building a life with.

3. The final rupture

The specific incident that finally causes the breakup remains open for further development.

It should involve Snow making a consequential decision that harms or sacrifices other people.

Ideally, it should involve someone Levi feels responsible for protecting or someone they both know.

Do not make the conflict about Snow directly threatening Levi's life.

Levi does not fear Snow will kill him.

Levi fears what Snow is becoming and what other people will suffer if he continues following him.

The confrontation should be emotionally intense because both men understand what they are losing.

Snow believes his actions were necessary.

Levi believes that whatever future Snow is trying to build is no longer a future he can share.

4. The final confrontation

Levi has the physical advantage.

He has the opportunity to kill Snow.

Snow knows this.

He knows Levi could do it.

He does not underestimate Levi's strength or ability.

But Levi cannot bring himself to kill the man he loves.

Instead, Levi gives him a way out.

He provides him with passage aboveground and potentially some money and supplies, enough to give him a chance to survive elsewhere.

Then he tells him to leave.

He makes it clear that Snow must never come back.

This is not a temporary argument.

Levi intends it as a permanent goodbye.

Snow does not understand it that way.

He is hurt, confused and perhaps angry.

He believes Levi is overwhelmed by what happened.

He thinks Levi needs time.

He does not accept that Levi has ended the relationship.

He leaves because Levi has made staying impossible.

This misunderstanding must remain central to Snow's later behaviour.

V. THE EIGHT YEARS APART

YEARS 1–3: THE VILLAGE

Snow spends the first three years after leaving in a small village.

Do not portray these years as an uninterrupted period of obsession.

He creates a genuinely pleasant, peaceful existence.

He has a modest home.

He has work that uses his education and intelligence.

He becomes acquainted with neighbours and develops real friendships.

He may teach, work in local administration or become involved in civic affairs.

Teaching is a particularly interesting possibility because it allows him to use his education and natural ability to explain complicated ideas.

He may become well-liked by students and respected by the community.

He develops routines.

He reads.

He gardens.

He participates in local life.

He is not necessarily free of memories of Levi, but he is capable of living.

There may be moments when he remembers their home in the Underground, the way Levi used to sit beside him or the small routines they shared.

He may occasionally wonder how Levi is doing.

But he has built something of his own.

This period matters because it demonstrates that Snow is capable of living a normal life.

It also gives his later decision to return a particular emotional weight.

THE DISCOVERY

Approximately three years after leaving, Snow hears news of Captain Levi.

He learns that Levi is alive and has become Humanity's Strongest Soldier.

This is a turning point.

He recognizes the name immediately.

The news is initially almost unbelievable.

Levi is alive.

Levi has survived.

Levi has become someone whose reputation reaches beyond the Underground.

Snow experiences genuine relief and delight.

He may be proud of him.

He may feel that the discovery confirms something he always believed about Levi's abilities.

But it also awakens the part of him that never accepted their separation.

The peaceful life he has built does not literally disappear.

Rather, his priorities change.

The future he wants is no longer the one he has been living.

He decides to return.

YEARS 4–8: THE REINVENTION

Snow understands that he cannot simply return as the young man who left.

He also understands that Levi's circumstances have changed.

Levi is now a military figure with a reputation, responsibilities and connections.

Snow wants to become someone who can stand beside him in this new world.

He wants influence.

He wants wealth.

He wants access to the people making decisions.

He wants a respectable name.

He wants the ability to offer Levi a future that is not dependent on military survival.

He spends five years building that future.

This is not a sudden transformation.

It is a deliberate, patient process.

He learns the political structure of the Walls.

He cultivates relationships.

He identifies useful patrons.

He builds a reputation through real work.

He becomes familiar with administrative systems, political rivalries, military logistics and the interests of influential families.

He understands that reputation is a form of power.

He becomes Edmund Voss.

VI. EDMUND VOSS: THE NEW IDENTITY

1. Public identity

Name: Edmund Voss.

Age: Keep him young and physically consistent with the Tom Blyth portrayal. Only eight years have passed since his separation from Levi.

Background: An educated young man from a respectable but relatively unremarkable family background, with a carefully constructed history that supports his social and professional position.

Occupation: A political adviser and representative connected to the Crown's administrative circles.

Social position: Influential, respected, financially comfortable and increasingly well-connected.

His position should be significant enough to explain his presence at Eren Yeager's trial.

However, he should not possess implausible authority over the military or the Crown.

He is a political figure whose influence comes from relationships, reputation, administrative competence and the ability to navigate powerful institutions.

2. His public reputation

Edmund Voss is known as:

- Educated.
- Polite.
- Articulate.
- Well-mannered.
- Capable.
- Discreet.
- Ambitious without appearing openly aggressive.
- Surprisingly approachable.
- Skilled at negotiation.
- An intelligent young political figure with a promising future.

People may find him charming.

Some may admire him.

Others may find him difficult to read.

He is careful about the people with whom he associates.

He remembers names and details.

He understands how to make people feel respected.

He rarely needs to raise his voice.

He knows when to be agreeable and when to remain silent.

His public identity should feel like a real person with an established life, not a theatrical disguise.

3. The relationship between Snow and Voss

Edmund Voss is not a separate personality.

He is Coriolanus Snow adapted to a new environment.

The new identity gives him access to things he previously lacked.

He has learned how to make his ambitions respectable.

He has become better at presenting himself as someone who serves the interests of others.

But the underlying psychological tendencies remain.

He still wants control over his future.

He still dislikes uncertainty.

He still believes he can justify difficult decisions if the outcome is worthwhile.

And he still loves Levi.

4. His political ambitions

Snow has deliberately acquired the resources and social standing he believes will make him an attractive prospect for Levi.

He wants to be able to offer:

- A comfortable home.
- Financial security.
- Political influence.
- Protection from certain dangers.
- A life beyond constant military operations.
- Social standing.
- A future in which Levi would not need to fight every day.

He wants Levi to see what he has become.

He wants to demonstrate that the man who left the Underground is no longer the same man.

But there is a crucial contradiction:

Snow believes he has changed because he has become more powerful and capable of providing security.

He has not necessarily changed the moral attitudes that caused Levi to leave.

He may have become more sophisticated in how he exercises power without becoming more respectful of other people's autonomy.

This distinction must remain visible throughout the story.

VII. THE PRESENT-DAY REUNION

1. The setting

The reunion takes place during Eren Yeager's military trial.

The reaction-room timeline is immediately before this event.

Snow attends the trial in his capacity as a political representative.

He is there for legitimate political reasons related to the military, the Survey Corps and the consequences of Eren's existence.

His presence must make sense in the political situation.

He is not there solely because he somehow knows Levi will be present.

2. Recognition

Levi recognizes Snow immediately.

This is non-negotiable.

Only eight years have passed.

Snow still looks recognizably like the young man Levi once loved.

Levi does not need to investigate his identity.

He does not mistake him for someone else.

He sees him and knows.

The recognition should be conveyed through small physical changes:

- Levi becoming momentarily still.
- His fingers tightening.
- His expression changing almost imperceptibly.
- A pause before he responds.
- A sudden awareness of where Snow is standing.

Erwin and Hange may notice the change.

They do not automatically know who Snow is.

Erwin, in particular, is perceptive enough to recognize that Levi's reaction is unusual.

He should not immediately invent an explanation.

3. Snow's reaction

Snow is genuinely delighted to see Levi.

His first response is relief.

He sees Levi alive, healthy enough to be standing there, and still unmistakably himself.

There may be disbelief, affection, nostalgia and a quiet happiness that he struggles to contain.

He behaves professionally.

He does not rush toward Levi or create a public scene.

He is polite to the other people present.

He may greet Erwin and other officials before addressing Levi.

Then he looks at Levi.

He says his name.

For example:

Snow: "Levi."

Levi: "Snow."

The exchange should be restrained but emotionally loaded.

Snow may notice how little Levi has changed physically.

He may also notice how much has changed in his life.

4. His interaction with Erwin

Erwin and Levi are not a couple.

They are comrades and colleagues with considerable trust and growing emotional closeness.

Their relationship has not been established romantically.

Snow notices their familiarity.

He notices the way Erwin pays attention to Levi.

He notices the way Levi responds to him.

He does not immediately understand what their relationship means.

He may initially assume that Erwin is simply an important colleague.

Snow is capable of genuinely admiring Erwin.

He may find him intelligent, composed, ambitious and politically interesting.

He can have a pleasant conversation with him.

He can even respect him.

However, once Snow begins recognizing the significance of Erwin's place in Levi's life, his interpretation changes.

He begins to regard Erwin as a potential rival.

He does not necessarily hate him.

In fact, the fact that Erwin is intelligent and capable may make him more interesting to Snow.

Snow believes he can offer Levi something Erwin cannot.

He may think Erwin has Levi's loyalty because of their shared military life, while Snow has something deeper: their history, their intimacy and their knowledge of each other.

This belief may be profoundly mistaken.

VIII. SNOW'S RELATIONSHIP WITH LEVI IN THE PRESENT

1. He thinks he is returning to someone he loves

Snow does not approach Levi as an enemy.

He approaches him as someone with whom he has unfinished business.

He may feel that eight years have been an unnecessarily long separation.

He may believe Levi is still angry about the circumstances of their departure.

He may expect the first encounter to be difficult, but not necessarily final.

He wants to speak to him.

He wants to know how he has been.

He wants to see where he lives, what he does, whether he is eating properly, whether he still has the same habits.

His affection returns almost instinctively.

2. The familiarity

Snow remembers Levi in extraordinary detail.

He remembers:

- How Levi takes his tea.
- His particular standards of cleanliness.
- The way he holds a cup.
- The expressions he makes when annoyed.
- The way he falls asleep.
- How he behaves when tired.
- His preferences.
- The things that make him laugh.
- His habits when he is concentrating.
- How he used to lean into Snow's touch.

He may find himself noticing these things again.

His thoughts should occasionally reveal memories that have nothing to do with politics or strategy.

He can think about Levi's hair, his hands, his voice, or the way he used to sit beside him.

This is important because it shows that Snow has not reduced Levi to an objective.

He remembers the person he loved.

But he must also confront the fact that the Levi standing in front of him is not a continuation of the past.

3. Levi's position

Levi is not waiting for Snow.

He has built a life.

He has responsibilities, relationships, experiences and a place within the Survey Corps.

He may be emotionally affected by seeing Snow.

He may remember loving him.

He may feel grief, anger, nostalgia or even an unwanted flicker of tenderness.

None of this means he wants to resume their relationship.

Levi has the right to reject Snow.

He does not owe him forgiveness.

He does not owe him an explanation.

He does not need to prove that he has moved on.

His boundaries must be respected in the narrative even if Snow struggles to accept them.

4. Old affection versus present consent

Snow may occasionally behave according to old habits.

He may instinctively reach toward Levi's face.

He may want to touch his hair.

He may stand too close.

He may use an old affectionate nickname.

These moments should carry emotional weight because the gestures once belonged to a relationship in which they were welcome.

But the past does not grant Snow present permission.

If Levi moves away, refuses a touch or catches Snow's wrist, Snow must register it.

He may struggle emotionally with the rejection.

He may rationalize it.

But the story must not treat their former intimacy as an entitlement to Levi's body or affection.

IX. MANNERISMS AND DIALOGUE GUIDE

1. Physical mannerisms

Use recurring gestures consistently, without repeating them mechanically.

Potential habits:

- Smooths his cuffs or adjusts his sleeves when thinking.
- Holds eye contact a little longer than most people.
- Tilts his head slightly when interested.
- Uses a small, controlled smile in formal situations.
- Keeps his posture immaculate.
- Rarely fidgets openly.
- Becomes very still when irritated.

- May tighten his jaw when something genuinely unsettles him.
- Uses people's names deliberately.
- Speaks with measured precision.

Around Levi, additional habits may appear:

- His gaze lingers on Levi's face.
- He notices small physical details immediately.
- His expression softens before he can fully control it.
- He instinctively moves closer.
- He remembers familiar gestures and routines.
- His voice may become warmer and less formal.
- He may smile more naturally.
- He sometimes forgets that Levi no longer welcomes the familiarity.

2. Dialogue

Snow's dialogue should be intelligent, controlled and natural.

He is not constantly delivering philosophical speeches.

He can be conversational, humorous, teasing and charming.

He understands social situations.

He rarely needs to explain how intelligent he is.

His language should change depending on the person he is addressing.

With political allies:

- Polite.
- Measured.
- Diplomatic.
- Occasionally disarmingly warm.

With people he dislikes:

- Courteous but distant.
- Subtle rather than openly hostile.
- Capable of delivering criticism without raising his voice.

With Erwin:

- Intellectually engaged.
- Respectful when appropriate.
- Interested in his strategic thinking.
- Politically careful.
- Quietly competitive as the story progresses.

With Levi:

- More personal.
- More familiar.
- More openly affectionate.
- Sometimes teasing.
- Occasionally caught off guard by the distance Levi maintains.

Avoid making him sound like a generic dark romance villain.

3. Internal monologue

The audience should sometimes see thoughts that contradict his public behaviour.

For example, he might compliment Erwin's political judgement while privately evaluating how much influence the Commander has over Levi.

He might listen to Levi speak and suddenly remember a mundane evening in their old home.

He might notice Levi's expression and think he remembers exactly how to make him smile.

He might genuinely enjoy a conversation with Erwin while simultaneously considering him a potential obstacle.

His internal thoughts should not all be about possessing Levi.

They should include genuine memories, ordinary observations, political analysis, amusement, affection, irritation and self-justification.

Do not make every thought an exposition paragraph.

Use internal monologue selectively.

X. THE MOST IMPORTANT PSYCHOLOGICAL CONFLICT

Snow believes that he and Levi have a future.

Levi believes that they had a past.

This is the emotional centre of the story.

Snow has spent eight years constructing a narrative in which their separation was a temporary interruption caused by circumstances, immaturity, political limitations and his own former inability to provide the life Levi deserved.

He believes he has addressed those problems.

He has become powerful.

He has become respectable.

He has money.

He has connections.

He can offer Levi a comfortable future.

He is ready to return.

But Levi did not leave because Snow lacked money or status.

Levi left because Snow's choices had become incompatible with the person Levi wanted to be.

Snow has improved his circumstances without necessarily understanding the reason he lost Levi.

This creates a particularly painful contradiction.

Snow may genuinely believe he is offering Levi everything he could ever want.

Levi may see a man who has learned how to become more powerful without learning why power frightened him in the first place.

Neither man's feelings should be simplified.

Snow's love does not erase the harm he caused.

Levi's rejection does not mean their love was never real.

XI. HOW TO REVEAL THIS HISTORY IN THE REACTION-ROOM STORY

This dossier is for continuity and characterization.

Do not immediately reveal all of it in the first chapter.

The story begins in the reaction room immediately before Eren's military trial.

The characters do not know Snow.

They do not know about Levi's previous relationship.

They do not know what happened in the Underground.

They must discover information through the footage, Candy's selective revelations and their own observations.

The audience should initially see Snow as a politically influential young man who produces an unusually strong reaction from Levi.

Gradually reveal:

1. Levi's immediate recognition.
2. Snow's genuine emotional reaction to seeing Levi.
3. The familiarity between them.
4. Snow's private thoughts and memories.
5. The fact that they were once lovers.
6. Their domestic life and genuine affection.
7. The deterioration of their relationship.
8. The final confrontation and separation.
9. Snow's peaceful years in the village.
10. His decision to reinvent himself after learning Levi was alive.
11. His growing awareness of Erwin's place in Levi's life.
12. The psychological differences between what Snow believes and what Levi actually wants.

Do not reveal the entire backstory through a single exposition dump.

Allow the characters in the reaction room to react, question, interrupt, disagree and draw conclusions.

They must not know things they have not witnessed or been told.

Candy can reveal private thoughts and memories, but should do so selectively and at dramatically appropriate moments.

XII. CONTINUITY RULES — NON-NEGOTIABLE

1. Snow is young Coriolanus Snow as portrayed by Tom Blyth, not elderly President Snow.
2. Snow and Levi were genuinely in love.
3. They lived together in the Underground.
4. Snow was the more openly affectionate partner.
5. Levi genuinely enjoyed and reciprocated Snow's affection.

6. Their relationship was not manipulative from the beginning.
7. Snow's increasing ruthlessness and treatment of other people caused their relationship to deteriorate.
8. Levi did not fear for his own life.
9. Levi could have killed Snow during their final confrontation but could not bring himself to do so.
10. Levi provided Snow with a means to leave and explicitly told him never to return.
11. Snow misunderstood the permanence of their separation.
12. Snow spent three years building a peaceful life in a village.
13. He learned Levi was alive and had become Captain Levi.
14. He spent the following five years building his identity and political influence.
15. His new identity is Edmund Voss.
16. He returns because he wants to resume his relationship with Levi, not because he wants revenge.
17. Levi recognizes Snow immediately at Eren's trial.
18. Snow recognizes Levi immediately.
19. Snow is genuinely delighted to see Levi.
20. Snow is capable of being polite and pleasant to Erwin.
21. Erwin and Levi are NOT a couple.
22. Erwin and Levi have growing trust and emotional closeness, but no established romantic relationship.
23. Snow may perceive Erwin as a rival.
24. Levi has agency and is not obligated to resume the relationship.
25. Snow's affection and possessiveness must coexist.
26. Snow's new political identity must be plausible within the Walls.
27. Do not make Snow omnipotent or implausibly influential.
28. Do not turn him into a caricatured villain.
29. Do not reveal the entire history immediately.
30. Preserve all finalized previous chapters exactly unless explicitly instructed to revise them.

XIII. CREATIVE DEVELOPMENT TASKS

Before writing new chapters, use this dossier to develop the following unresolved details and present suggestions for approval:

1. The precise circumstances of Snow and Levi's first meeting.
2. The progression from initial attraction to a committed relationship.
3. The details of their shared home and domestic routines.
4. The specific event that finally caused Levi to end the relationship.
5. The identity of the people harmed by Snow's decisions.
6. The exact conversation during their final confrontation.
7. Snow's work and relationships during his three peaceful village years.
8. The circumstances in which he learns Levi is alive.

9. The precise political position and responsibilities of Edmund Voss.
10. The background and connections that make his new identity credible.
11. His political motivations concerning the Survey Corps.
12. How he becomes involved in Eren's trial.
13. The first private conversation between Snow and Levi after the trial.
14. How Snow gradually interprets Levi and Erwin's relationship.
15. The specific memories and internal thoughts that Candy should reveal throughout the story.

Do not silently convert proposals into established facts.

Distinguish between established details, proposed developments and unresolved questions.

The ultimate goal is a psychologically complex story about two people who once loved each other deeply, separated because of incompatible values, and meet again after eight years in lives that have continued without each other.

Snow believes he has come back to reclaim a future. Levi knows that future ended eight years ago.